

LESSON 6

The Paael Stem: Intensive, Factitive, and Formal Religious Action

ܐܠܠܗ

PĀ'EL

Worship and religious vocabulary · Conflict with established religion

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–5

Cumulative Review

Lesson 6 builds directly on Lesson 5. You should now be comfortable with the Aphel stem (causative). This lesson introduces its close sibling: the Paael, the intensive/factitive stem.

- **Lesson 5 review:** The Aphel stem: 'a- prefix, causative meaning ("to cause X"). Perfect paradigm (' allep), participle (ma 'lep). Comparison with Hebrew Hiphil and Arabic Form IV.
- **Lessons 1–4 recap:** Estrangela alphabet; noun states, pronouns and verbless clauses; the Peal participle with enclitics (present); the Peal perfect (past); pronominal suffixes and 'it l- ("to have").

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions before proceeding. Answers in Section 8.

1. Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of the root q-r-b (draw near) and translate it.
2. ܐܠܠܗ — what form is this? What is its root and stem?
3. Translate: ܪܘܗܐ ܐܒܝܐܝܬܐ (Rūḥā 'aglī šrārā)
4. What is the Hebrew Hiphil equivalent of the Syriac Aphel? Give one example.
5. Give the Aphel participle (all four forms) of root 'l-p (teach).

SECTION 2: THE PAAEL STEM

Core Meaning: Intensive and Factitive

The Paael stem (also spelled Pael or Pā'el) expresses two related types of intensified meaning:

- **Intensive:** Repeated, thoroughgoing, or heightened action. ‘He wrote’ (Peal) → ‘he wrote carefully/copied out’ (Paael).
- **Factitive:** Causing someone or something to enter into a state. ‘Be holy’ (Peal) → ‘make holy/sanctify’ (Paael). The Paael turns intransitive verbs into transitive ones.

Formation: Gemination of the Middle Root Letter

The defining feature of the Paael is the **doubling (gemination) of the middle root consonant (R2)**. This is written with a *dageš*-like diacritic in pointing, or simply by writing the letter twice in some scripts.

- **Perfect:** CaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern — e.g., barrek (from b-r-k), qaddaš (from q-d-š), yallep (from y-l-p)
- **Participle:** mCaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern (m- prefix) — e.g., mbarrek, mqaddeš, myallep

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

- **Hebrew Piel:** The direct cognate of the Syriac Paael. Also formed by doubling R2. Compare: *kipper* (Piel, ‘atone/cover’ — from k-p-r), *bērak* (Piel, ‘bless’ — from b-r-k), *qiddēš* (Piel, ‘sanctify’). The structural identity is near-perfect.
- **Arabic Form II:** Formed by doubling R2 (qaddama, ‘to present/offer’; ‘allama, ‘to teach/instruct’; qaddasa, ‘to sanctify’). Arabic Form II corresponds precisely to Syriac Paael in both form and function.
- **Greek:** No direct morphological equivalent. Intensives expressed via prefix verbs (e.g., *κατα-* compounds), aspect (perfect), or adverbs. Latin uses intensifying prefixes or separate lexical items.

Paael Examples: Peal → Paael

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Paael (Syr)	Paael Translit	Paael Meaning
ܒܪܟܝܢ b-r-k	'kneel,	ܒܪܟܝܢ barre bless (Peal)'	ܟܒܪܟܝܢ k 'bless/prono	unce	'blessing'
ܩܕܝܫܐ q-d-š'	be holy	ܩܕܝܫܐ qadda (Peal)'	ܫܒܪܟܝܢ š 'sanctify/make	holyl'	
ܥܠܝܢ y-l-p	'learn	ܥܠܝܢ yalle (Peal)'	ܡܥܠܝܢ p 'teach (ma	ke	'learned)'
ܫܡܫܐ š-m-š	'serve	ܫܡܫܐ šamme (Peal)'	ܫܡܫܐ š 'minister/s	erve	'formally'
ܕܠܝܬܐ k-n-š	'gather	ܕܠܝܬܐ kanne (Peal)'	ܫܕܠܝܬܐ š 'assemble/col	lect'	

KEY INSIGHT: When the Paael is applied to an INTRANSITIVE verb (e.g., 'be holy'), it makes the action TRANSITIVE and FACTITIVE: 'make X holy / sanctify.' This is called the factitive use, and it is the Paael's most theologically important function. Compare Hebrew Piel kipper ('atone'), qiddēš ('sanctify'), bērak ('bless').

Comparison of the Three Major Stems

Syriac	Peal (basic)	Paael (intensive/factitive)	Aphel (causative)
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy')	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy')	—
b-r-k	berak ('kneel')	barrek ('bless intensively')	—
k-t-b	katab ('write')	katteb ('write carefully/copy') ('	'akteb dictate/cause to write')
y-l-p	yalep ('learn')	yallep ('teach — make 'al learned')	lep ('cause to learn')
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve')	šammeš ('minister formally')	—

SECTION 3: PAAEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: ‘to bless’

ברך Perfect — Full Conjugation (Root b-r-k)

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בִּרְכָּה *barrek	* he bl	essed
3 f.sg.	בִּרְכָּה *barreka	t* she b	lessed
2 m.sg.	בִּרְכָּה *barrek	t* you (m.sg	.) blessed
2 f.sg.	בִּרְכָּה *barrekt	i* you (f.sg	.) blessed
1 c.sg.	בִּרְכָּה *barreki	t* I bl	essed
3 m.pl.	בִּרְכּוּ *barrek	ū* they (m.	) blessed
3 f.pl.	בִּרְכּוּ *barrek	ī* they (f.	) blessed
2 m.pl.	בִּרְכֶּם *barrekit	ūn* you (m.pl	.) blessed
2 f.pl.	בִּרְכֶּם *barrekit	in* you (f.pl	.) blessed
1 c.pl.	בִּרְכּוּ *barreki	n* we bl	essed

Formation Notes

- **Root:** b-r-k. In the Paael, R2 (resh, r) is geminated: b-rr-k → barrek
- **Perfect vowel pattern:** a under R1, doubled R2, e vowel between R2 and R3 (same as Peal CeCC but with geminate R2)
- **Suffix set:** Essentially identical to Peal and Aphel perfect suffixes
- **Guttural roots:** When R2 is a guttural (Ayin, Het, He, Alaph), gemination may be ‘virtual’ — compensatory lengthening of the preceding vowel occurs instead

Comparison: Hebrew Piel Perfect

The Hebrew Piel perfect is structurally near-identical to the Syriac Paael perfect. Compare:

Person	Hebrew (Piel)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בָּרַךְ	bērāk	he blessed (Piel b-r-k)
3 f.sg.	בָּרְכָה	bērēkāh	she blessed
1 c.sg.	בָּרַכְתִּי	bēraktī	I blessed
3 m.pl.	בָּרְכוּ	bērēkū	they blessed

SECTION 4: PAAEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: ‘one who blesses’

The Paael active participle takes the same m- prefix as all derived-stem participles. The gemination of R2 is preserved throughout.

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܐ *mbarre	k* blessing	(m.sg.)
f.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܬܐ *mbarrk	ā* blessing	(f.sg.)
m.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܝܢ *mbarrkī	n* blessing	(m.pl.)
f.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܬܝܢ *mbarrkā	n* blessing	(f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- (identical to Aphel participle prefix)
- **Vowel pattern:** m + a + R1R2R2 + e + R3 (preserves gemination of R2)
- **Suffixes:** Standard participle endings: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Piel participle: prefix נִ (mē-) + doubled R2. E.g., *mēbārēk* (blessing, from b-r-k Piel), *mēqaddēš* (sanctifying, from q-d-š Piel). Structurally identical to Syriac Paael participle.

Arabic Form II active participle: pattern muCaCCiC (mu + R1 + a + R2R2 + i + R3). E.g., *mu‘allim* (teacher, from ‘-l-m Form II), *muqaddis* (sanctifier, from q-d-s Form II). The m- prefix and gemination are pan-

Semitic features.

SECTION 5: WORSHIP AND RELIGIOUS VOCABULARY

Paael Verbs for Worship and Ministry

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Notes
ܒܪܟܐ barrek	Paael b-r-k	bless,	Cf. Heb Pie pronounce blessing	l bērak; Arabic bāraka
ܠܬ laṭ	Peal l-ṭ	curse	Antonym of ba	rrek; cf. Heb qillēl
ܫܠܝ šallī	Paael š-l-y	pray,	Cf. Heb hit intercede	pallēl; Arabic šallā
ܫܥܕ sgad	Peal s-g-d	bow down,	Cf. Arabic sa worship	jada; Heb hištaḥawāh
ܫܡܡܝܫ šammeš	Paael š-m-š	minister,	Liturgical se serve formally	rvice; cf. Hebrew šimmeš
ܝܠܦ yallep	Paael y-l-p	teach,	Factitive of instruct	‘learn’; cf. Arabic ‘allama
ܩܕܕܝܫ qaddaš	Paael q-d-š	sanctify,	Cf. Heb Piel make holy	qiddēš; Arabic qaddasa
ܫܒܚܫ šabbēh	Paael š-b-ḥ	praise,	Cf. Syriac glorify	šūbhā (glory); doxological use
ܩܒܠ qabbel	Paael q-b-l	receive,	Cf. Arabic qa accept (ritual)	bila; used for receiving sacraments
ܡܠܠ mallel	Paael m-l-l	speak,	Intensive of converse, preach	speech; cf. Heb millēl
ܕܩܕܕ dakkī	Paael d-k-y	purify,	Factitive cleanse	of ‘be pure’; cf. Heb Piel zikkāh
ܡܫܗܝܬ mašeḥ	Paael m-š-ḥ	anoint, smear	Root of m with oil	ēšīḥā (Messiah/Christ); cf. Heb māšaḥ
ܫܡ šam	Peal š-w-m	fast, abstain	Cf. Heb šûm	; Arabic šāma
ܚܓܓ ḡagag	Peal ḡ-g-g	feast,	Cf. Heb ḡāga celebrate	g; Arabic ḡajja

Nouns for Temple, Worship, and Religious Community

Estrangela	Translit	Meaning	Notes
ܡܕܒܚܐ madbhā	altar	From d-b-ḥ (	slaughter/sacrifice); cf. Heb mizbēah
ܟܗܢܐ kahnā	priest	Cf. Heb k	ōhēn; Arabic kāhin
ܗܝܟܠ hayklā	temple,	Cf. Heb h sanctuary	ēkāl (from Akkadian ēkallu); Gk naos
ܩܢܝܬܐ knūštā	synagogue,	From k-n-š (g assembly	ather); cf. Heb kēneset
ܩܘܪܒܢܐ qūrbānā	offering,	From q-r-b (	draw near/offer); cf. Heb qorbān (Mark 7:11)
ܒܫܡܐ besmā	incense, spic	e Cf. Heb b	ōšem; Arabic balsam
ܡܝܝܐ mayyā	water	Pl. form sta	ndard; cf. Heb mayim, Arabic mā
ܡܫܗܐ mešhā	oil, ointment	From m-š-ḥ (a	noint); root of Messiah
ܠܗܡܐ lahmā	bread, food	Cf. Heb le	hem (Bethlehem = bēt lehem); Arabic lahm
ܟܣܐ kāsā	cup	Cf. Heb	kôs; Gk potērion
ܢܡܘܫܐ nāmūsā	law, Torah	From Gk	nomos via Aramaic
ܫܠܬܐ šlūttā	prayer	Abstract no	un from š-l-y (Paael)
ܩܢܝܬܐ knūštā	assembly,	Also used for congregation	synagogue (same word)
ܩܘܕܢܐ pūqdānā	commandment,	From p-q-d (c decree	ommand); cf. Heb piqqūd
ܢܡܘܫܐ nāmūsā	law, rule	Dual use: T	orah and general law

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 6

Yukhannan Blesses the People and Angers the Priests

Narrative note: This passage is rich in Paael forms (barrek, ṣallī, šabbēh, yallep, qaddaš, šammeš). It also introduces the central conflict of the Acts: Yukhannan’s ministry challenges the established religious order. Notice the theological contrast between sacrifice (qūrbānā) and faith (haymānūttā).

Key Paael forms: *barrek* (blessed), *ṣallī* (prayed), *šabbēḥ* (praised), *yallep* (taught), *qaddaš* (sanctified), *šammeš* (minister), *šabbēḥ* (praised again at end). Note also *metqaddeš* — the *Ethpaael* (passive of Paael), previewing Lesson 7.

Sentence 1

ܐܡܡܐ ܠܝܠܝܢܐ ܒܪܟܬܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ ܥܠ ܡܕܒܗܐ

w-Yukhannan qam ʿ al madbhā w-barrek l- ʿ ammā

w- (and-) *Yukhannan* (John) *qam* (stood) ʿ *al* (upon) *madbhā* (the-altar) *w-barrek* (and-blessed) *l-* ʿ *ammā* (the-people)

→ *And Yukhannan stood at the altar and blessed the people.*

Sentence 2

ܐܠܗܐ ܠܡܢܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ ܐܡܠܝܢ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ

w-ṣallī b- ʿ ednā rāmā w-šabbēḥ l-Alāhā

w-ṣallī (and-prayed) *b-* ʿ *ednā* (with-voice) *rāmā* (loud) *w-šabbēḥ* (and-praised) *l-Alāhā* (God)

→ *He prayed with a loud voice and praised God.*

Sentence 3

ܡܬܥܠܡܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ ܡܕܒܗܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ

w-yallep lhūn ʿ ūrhā ḥattā d-šlūttā

w-yallep (and-taught) *lhūn* (them) ʿ *ūrhā* (the-way) *ḥattā* (new) *d-šlūttā* (of-prayer)

→ *He taught them the new way of prayer.*

Sentence 4

ܡܕܒܗܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ ܕܡܕܒܗܐ

w- ʿ emar: lā madbhā d-kahnūttā hū d-qaddaš ʿ enāš

w- 'emar (and-said) lā (not) madbhā (the-altar) d-kahnūtā (of-the-priesthood) hū (it-is) d-qaddaš (that-sanctifies) 'enāš (a-person)

→ *'It is not the altar of the priesthood that sanctifies a person.'*

Sentence 5

אלה מרביחין לך מלך מרביחין לך

'ellā Māryā hū d-qaddaš lkūn b-rūḥeh

'ellā (but/rather) Māryā (the-Lord) hū (he-is) d-qaddaš (who-sanctifies) lkūn (you(pl.)) b-rūḥeh (by-his-Spirit)

→ *'Rather, it is the Lord who sanctifies you by his Spirit.'*

Sentence 6

שמעו דין מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא

šme ' ū dēn kāhnē mellāw-hy w- 'etragzū 'lāw-hy

šme ' ū (heard) dēn (but/now) kāhnē (the-priests) mellāw-hy (his-words) w- 'etragzū (and-were-angered) 'lāw-hy (against-him)

→ *But the priests heard his words and were angered against him.*

Sentence 7

מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא

w- 'emrū: man yahab lāk šulṭānā d-šammeš b-hayklā?

w- 'emrū (and-they-said) man (who) yahab (gave) lāk (to-you) šulṭānā (authority) d-šammeš (to-minister) b-hayklā (in-the-temple)

→ *'Who gave you authority to minister in the temple?'*

Sentence 8

אלה מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא מלכא

'nā Yukhannan w- 'emar: Alāhā šedarnī d- 'qaddeš l- 'ammeh

‘ nā (answered) Yukhannan (Yukhannan) w- ’ emar (and-said) Alāhā (God) šedarnī (sent-me) d- ’ qaddeš (to-sanctify) l- ’ ammeh (his-people)

→ *Yukhannan answered: ‘God sent me to sanctify his people.’*

Sentence 9

לֹא בִּזְבָּחַן אֵלֶּא כִּי בִּיָּמָאנֻטָּא מֵתְקַדֵּשׁ אֵנָּשׁ

lā b-qūrbānā ’ ellā b-haymānūttā metqaddeš ’ enāš

lā (not) *b-qūrbānā* (by-sacrifice) *’ ellā* (but) *b-haymānūttā* (by-faith) *metqaddeš* (is-sanctified) *’ enāš* (a-person)

→ *‘A person is not sanctified by sacrifice but by faith.’*

Sentence 10

וְרֵגַז רַב כֹּהֲנֵי וּפְקַד דְּנֻפְּקֻן לֵה מֵן הַיִּכְלָא

w-regaz rab kahnē w-pqad d-nuppqūn leh men hayklā

w-regaz (and-was-enraged) *rab* (chief) *kahnē* (of-priests) *w-pqad* (and-commanded) *d-nuppqūn* (that-they-expel) *leh* (him) *men* (from) *hayklā* (the-temple)

→ *And the chief priest was enraged and commanded that they expel him from the temple.*

Sentence 11

יֻכְחָנָן דֵּן לֹא דְּחֵל אֵלֶּא כִּי שַׁבְּבֵהּ לֵאלֹהֵא בְּכֻלְּהּ לֵבְבֵהּ

Yukhannan dēn lā dḥel ’ ellā šabbeḥ l-Alāhā b-kulleh lebbeh

Yukhannan (Yukhannan) *dēn* (but/however) *lā* (not) *dḥel* (feared) *’ ellā* (but) *šabbeḥ* (praised) *l-Alāhā* (God) *b-kulleh* (with-all) *lebbeh* (his-heart)

→ *But Yukhannan was not afraid; rather he praised God with all his heart.*

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification (Mixed: Peal, Paael, Aphel)

Identify each verb form: state the stem (Peal/Paael/Aphel), person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	ܒܪܝܟ	barrek
2	ܟܬܒ	katab
3	ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb
4	ܫܒܒܗ	šabbeḥ
5	ܐܗܝܝ	'aḥyī
6	ܡܒܪܟ	mbarrek
7	ܩܕܕܫ	qaddaš
8	ܡܠܦ	ma'lep
9	ܫܡܡܝܫ	šammeš
10	ܫܓܕ	sgad
11	ܫܠܝ	šallī
12	ܐܠܠܦ	'allep

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Paael verbs in the perfect (10 persons) and the participle (4 forms). Use Sections 3–4 as a model.

1. Root *š-b-ḥ* (*praise*) — Paael: *šabbeḥ*
2. Root *m-l-l* (*speak*) — Paael: *mallel*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences, all containing Paael verbs.

1. ܝܘܗܢܢܢ ܒܪܝܟ ܠܥܡܡܐ (*Yūḥannan barrek l- 'ammā*)
2. ܕܡܠܦ ܫܡܡܝܫ ܒܗܝܟܠܐ (*Kāhnā šammeš b-hayklā*)

3. חַיָּהּ בְּחַדְדֵּשָׁת לִבְנָיָהּ (Hī qaddešat l-bnāy-hy)
4. מְבָרֵק עֲנָה לֵאלֹהֵי (Mbarrek 'enā l-Alāhā)
5. יָבִישׁ לְכָל יוֹמֵי הַיּוֹם (Šabbhū l-Māryā b-kull yawm)
6. אֲנִי יָלַפְתִּי לָנָם נָאֻסָּה ('Ant yallapt lān nāmūsā)
7. דַּכְּכִי מַיְיָ לְמַא' מִדִּיטָה (Dakkī mayyā l-ma' mūdittā)
8. מִן מְשַׁח בְּמֶשְׁחָהּ (Man mšaḥ b-mešḥā?)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Pael)

Render these sentences into Syriac using the Pael stem.

1. The prophet blessed the offering.
2. They (m.) praised God with a loud voice.
3. The priest sanctified the assembly.
4. She prayed every day in the temple.
5. He anointed the king with oil.
6. We ministered to the Lord together.

Exercise 5: Peal vs. Pael Comparison

For each root pair below, explain how the Peal and Pael meanings differ, and give one example sentence using each.

Root	Pael Meaning	Pael Meaning
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy' Peal) qa	ddaš ('sanctify/make holy' Pael)
b-r-k	berak ('kneel/bless' Peal)	barrek ('bless solemnly' Pael)
y-l-p	yalep ('learn' Peal)	yallep ('teach, make learned' Pael)
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve' Peal) ša	mmeš ('minister formally' Pael)
d-k-y	dakī ('be pure' Peal)	dakkī ('purify, cleanse' Pael)

Exercise 6: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6, then answer the following questions.

1. What actions does Yuxhannan perform at the altar? (List the Paael verbs.)
2. What does Yuxhannan teach about the true source of sanctification?
3. How do the priests react, and why?
4. What authority does the chief priest invoke, and what does Yuxhannan claim?
5. What does Yuxhannan do after being threatened with expulsion? What does this tell us about his character?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

Section 1 Warm-Up

Q1: Aphel perf. 3 m.sg.: אָקֵר ('aqreb) = 'he brought near / offered'

Q2: Aphel active participle m.sg. of 'l-p (ma 'lep), 'teaching'

Q3: 'The Spirit revealed the truth.'

Q4: Hebrew Hiphil — e.g., hiqrīb (brought near, from q-r-b)

Q5: m.sg.: ma 'lep / f.sg.: ma 'lpā / m.pl.: ma 'lpīn / f.pl.: ma 'lpān

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Paael	3 m.sg.	b-r-k	he blessed
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
4	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-b-ḥ	he praised
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
6	Paael ptcp	m.sg.	b-r-k	blessing
7	Paael	3 m.sg.	q-d-š	he sanctified
8	Aphel ptcp	m.sg.	'-l-p	teaching (causative)
9	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-m-š	he ministered
10	Peal	3 m.sg.	s-g-d	he worshipped
11	Paael	3 m.sg.	ṣ-l-y	he prayed
12	Aphel	3 m.sg.	'-l-p	he taught (causative)

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	Yukhannan blessed the people.
2	The priest ministered in the temple.
3	She sanctified her children.
4	I am blessing God.
5	They praised the Lord every day.
6	You (m.sg.) taught us the law.
7	He purified the water for baptism.
8	Who anointed with oil?

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Nebīyā barrek l-qūrbānā*
2. *Šabbhū l-Alāhā b- 'ednā rāmā*
3. *Kāhnā qaddaš l-knūštā*
4. *šalleyyat b-kull yawm b-hayklā*
5. *Mšaḥ l-malkā b-mešḥā*
6. *Šammešnān l-Māryā ḥdāyīt*

Exercise 6: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	He blessed (barrek), prayed (šallī), praised (šabbēḥ), and taught (yallep).
2	Not the altar but the Lord, by his Spirit (b-rūḥeh).
3	They were angered (' etragzū) — he was bypassing priestly authority.
4	Priests claimed temple authority; Yukhannan claimed divine commission (šedarnī).
5	He praised God (šabbēḥ) — showing fearless devotion over fear of human authority.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PAEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Formation feature	Pattern	Example (b-r-k)
Root consonant pattern	R1 + R2 DOUBLED + R3	b-rr-k
Perfect 3 m.sg.	CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	barrek
Participle m.sg.	m + CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	mbarrek
Participle suffixes	-ā, -īn, -ān	mbarrkā, mbarrkīn, mbarrkān
Core meaning	Intensive or Factitive	'bless solemnly'; 'sanctify = make holy'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + R2 DOUBLED = PAAEL (intensive/factitive) ‘to X’ → ‘to X thoroughly’ or ‘to make X happen / cause X state’ *q-d-š: be holy* → *qaddaš: sanctify* | *b-r-k: bless* → *barrek: bless solemnly* | *y-l-p: learn* → *yallep: teach*

Three-Stem Comparison Table

Stem	Meaning Type	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	‘he wrote’ / ‘writing’
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	barrek	mbarrek	‘he blessed’ / ‘blessing’
Aphel	Causative	’ allep	ma ’lep	‘he taught’ / ‘teaching’

Semitic Language Family Comparison

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Meaning	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative
Hebrew (cognate)	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic (cognate)	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Formation key	Basic vowels	R2 DOUBLED	’ a- prefix

FINAL REMINDER: All three stems — Peal, Paael, and Aphel — share the same suffix set for the perfect and the same m- prefix for the active participle. The stems are distinguished by: (1) Peal: basic vowels only; (2) Paael: R2 gemination; (3) Aphel: ’ a- prefix.

LOOKING AHEAD — Lesson 7: The *Ethpeel* and *Ethpaael* (reflexive/passive stems). You have already seen *metqaddeš* in this lesson’s story — that is the *Ethpaael* passive of *qaddaš*. Soon you will master the full passive system of Syriac.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 10 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
דִּינָא	dīnā	m	judgment
קִדְדָּשָׁא	qaddāšā	m	make holy
קִדְדְּשֻׁתָּא	qaddšūtā	f	holiness
פִּלְגָּא	palggā	m	divide
פִּלְגְּשֻׁתָּא	palgūtā	f	division
סַגְגַּד	saggad	m	worship
סַגְדְּשֻׁתָּא	saḡdūtā	f	worship
פַּרְצַפְּא	parzappā	m	interpreter
מַרְמָא	marmā	m	raise, exalt
תַּפְּפָא	ṭappā	m	strike, beat